

User Manual

MediaDownloader

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About

This standalone desktop application allows you to download your favorite media files cleanly and quickly. Because this app is designed to run as a portable, self-contained bundle, you do not need to install Python or configure complex tools to use it.

Installation & First Time Launch

Because MediaDownloader is an unsigned standalone application, your operating system's security features might double-check it on your first launch. Follow these platform-specific steps to get up and running smoothly:

Windows

1. Download *MediaDownloader-Windows.zip*.
2. Right-click the .zip file and select **Extract All...** (Running the application from inside an unextracted zip will cause it to crash).
3. Open the extracted folder, look for *MediaDownloader.exe*, and double-click it.
4. Security Note: If a blue Windows SmartScreen window pops up saying "Windows protected your PC", click **More Info** and then click the **Run Anyway** button.

Mac OS

1. Download *MediaDownloader-MacOS.zip* and double-click it to extract the folder.
2. Open the folder, look for the *MediaDownloader* app icon.
3. **Do not double-click it normally on the first launch.** Instead, hold down the **Control (Ctrl)** key on your keyboard and click the app icon, then select **Open** from the menu.
4. Security Note: A prompt will ask if you are sure you want to open an unsigned app. Click **Open**. (You only have to do this once; future launches can be opened with a standard double-click).

Linux

1. Download *MediaDownloader-Linux.tar.gz*.
2. Extract the archive using your file manager or open your terminal and run:
 - `tar -xzvf MediaDownloader-Linux.tar.gz`
3. Navigate into the folder and ensure the binary has execution permissions:
 - `cd MediaDownloader`
 - `chmod +x MediaDownloader`
4. Run the application by double-clicking it or launching `./MediaDownloader` from your terminal.

How To Use the application

The interface looks as follows after launching it:



The interface is built to be simple and straightforward:

1. **Paste your link:** Copy the URL of the video and/or audio you want to download and paste it into the main input field.
2. **Select your options:** Choose your preferred video resolution or toggle the audio-only option if you just want an MP3 track.
3. **Hit Download:** Click the download button. The console log at the bottom will spring to life, showing you your current download speed, file sizing, and processing status.
4. **Access your files:** Once completed, the application will automatically pop open your system's File Explorer window directly to the destination folder you chose (if you have enabled the option in Settings) so you can see your files immediately.

Mode Selection Explained

The Mode Selection section with the two options are defined as such for:

- **Single URL:** The URL entered has both the video and the audio combined, for example: YouTube URLs
- **Split URL:** This one is for scenarios where the video you want to download splits its video in one URL and its audio in another URL, this is usually the case with `.m3u8` URLs where one URL is for video only and another one is for the audio only. In this case, the application uses `static-ffmpeg` to download the video and audio and then processes to merge them into a single video file.

Formats Explained

The Format Selection drop-down is available only when the selected mode is "Single URL" as explained above. This is so because in the back-end it uses YT-DLP to initiate the downloads and YT-DLP can take make different formats. Currently these are the following options to choose from:

- **Best Quality:** Gets the best quality and resolution of video available and the best audio available, if they are not already combined, proceeds to combine them into a single `.mkv` video file.

- **1080p**: Gets the video at a max resolution of 1080p (Full HD) and the best audio, if they are not already combined, proceeds to combine them into a single .mkv video file.
- **720p**: Gets the video at a max resolution of 720p and the best audio, if they are not already combined, proceeds to combine them into a single .mkv video file.
- **MP3 Audio only**: Gets only the best audio from the video and then processes it in an mp3 format at currently 320kpbs.
- **FLAC Audio only**: Gets only the best audio and then processes it in the lossless format of FLAC.

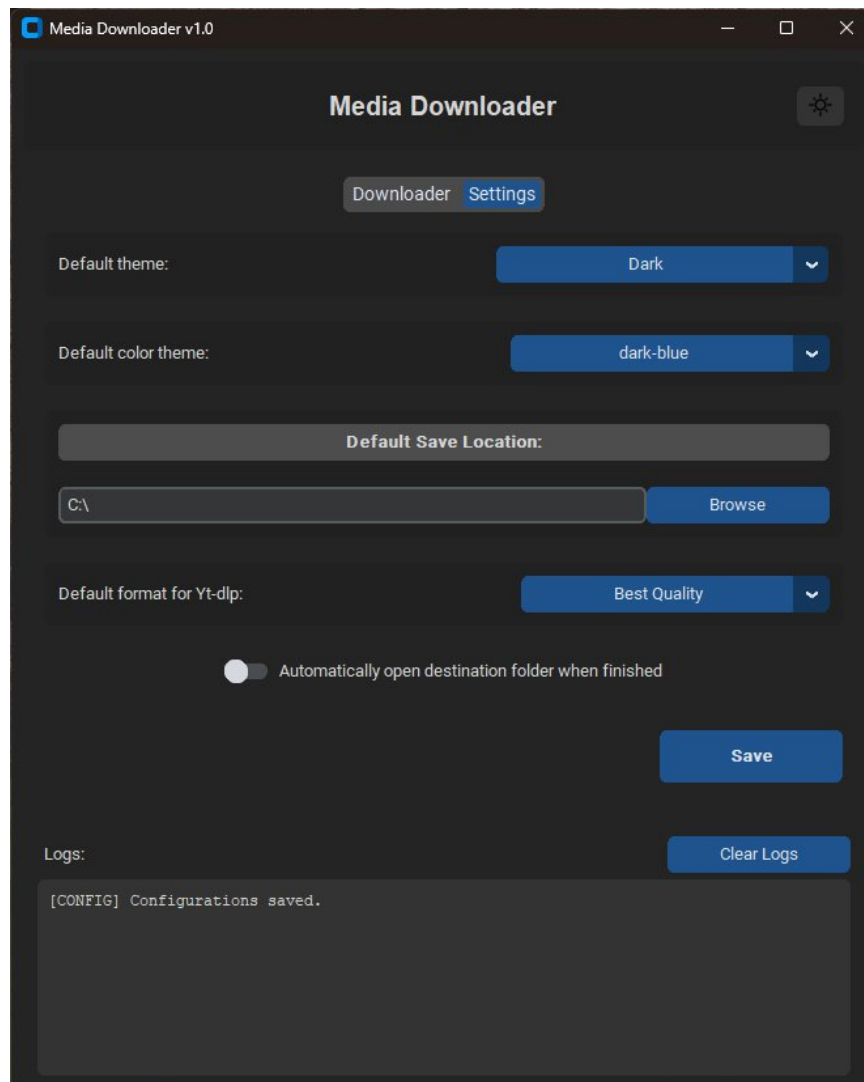
Downloading a simple video

To get into more details as to how to exactly download a video, below are listed the steps by steps guide:

1. Choose your destination folder to where you want your downloaded media to placed using the “Save Location” section and the “Browse” button.
2. Next, in “Mode Selection” choose “Single URL”.
3. Then, choose the format you want to download, usually “Best Quality”.
4. Enter your URL in the input box.
5. Hit the Download button.
6. Your download will start and you will see all of what is going on in the Logs section.
7. While your download is running, a progress bar and a Cancel button will appear. The Cancel button allows you to cancel the currently running download if you choose so.
8. Upon completion, a pop-up message will appear if it is a success or if an error has occurred.

Settings

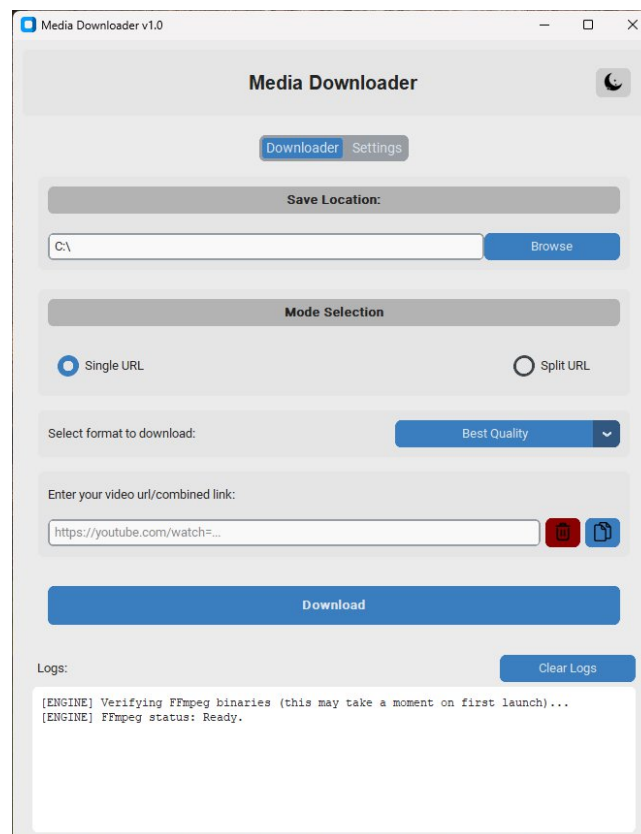
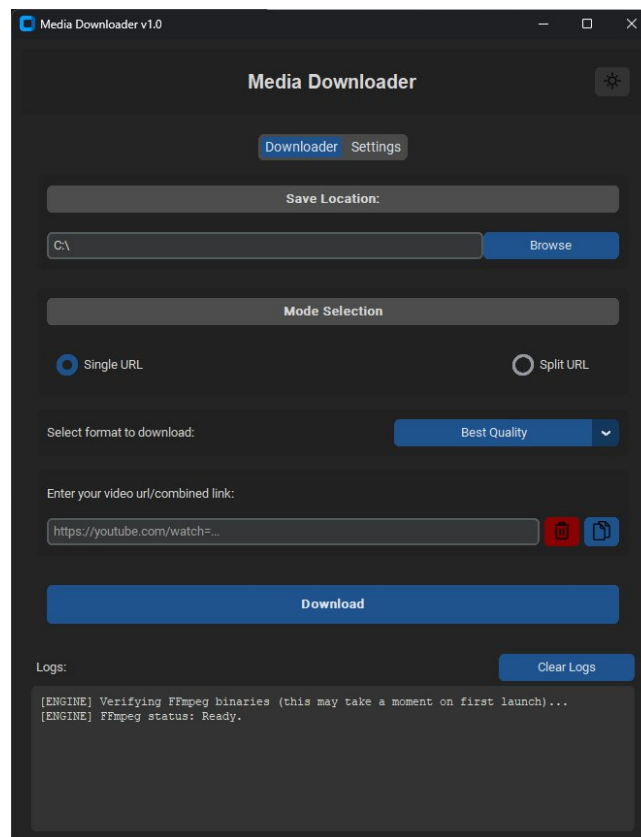
The Settings tab can be accessed by clicking the “Settings” tab just below the title of the application.

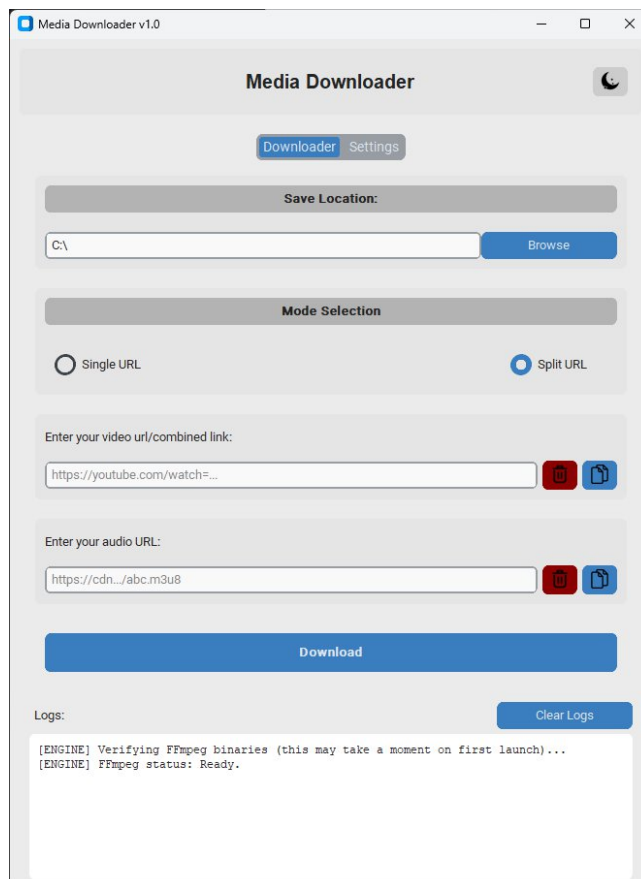
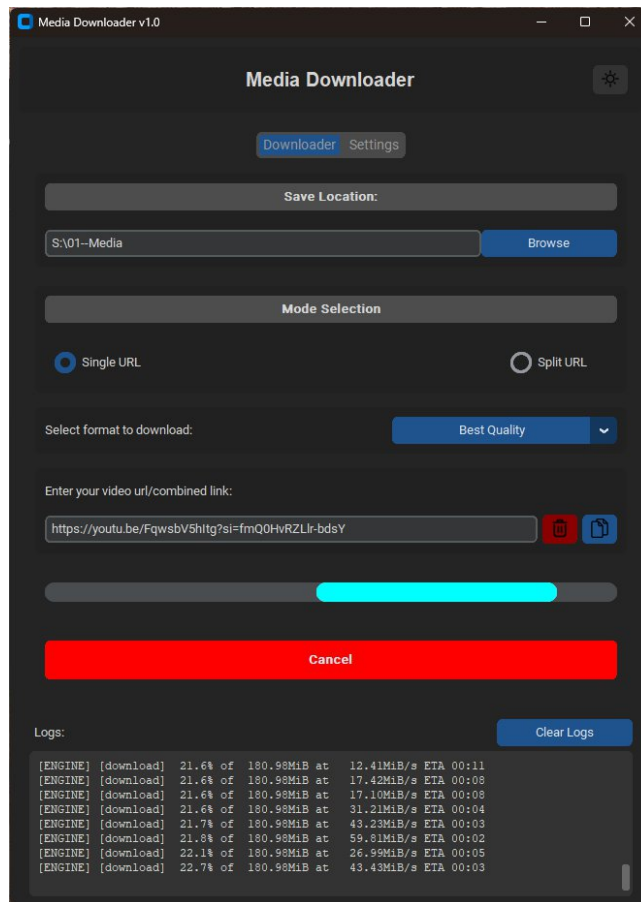


The settings tab allows the user to set some default preferred values so that the user does not have to set them each time upon launching the app.

- **Theme:** Dark or Light or System.
- **Color Theme:** Blue or Green or Dark Blue.
- **Save Location:** Default/Preferred location to where the downloaded files will be.
- **Format for YT-DLP:** Preferred format that YT-DLP will use to download the entered URL. (Only valid when choosing “Single URL” option)
- **Open destination folder when finished:** If toggled on, upon completion of a successful download, the chosen destination will be opened automatically.

Screenshots





Uninstallation

Simple uninstallation: just delete the main folder and the application is gone.

If you ever want to completely wipe the application from your machine, simply deleting the main folder leaves behind a couple of tiny hidden runtime cache files. Follow these steps for a 100% clean removal:

1. Send your main **MediaDownloader** directory to the Recycle Bin/Trash.
2. Clear the Core Media Engine Cache:
 - *Windows:* Press Win + R, type %localappdata%, press **Enter**, and delete the *static_ffmpeg* folder.
 - *Mac/Linux:* Navigate to your home directory, toggle hidden files on (Cmd + Shift + . on Mac), and delete the *.static_ffmpeg* cache directory.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

Q: *The app starts up but downloads are failing immediately or hanging.*

- **The Fix:** MediaDownloader downloads a tiny background networking component (static-ffmpeg) upon its very first run. If your internet connection was interrupted or your antivirus aggressively blocked it, the file might be corrupted. Close the app, perform the **Complete Uninstallation** steps above, reopen the app, and give it a minute to reinitialize on a clean connection.

Q: *Can I close the app mid-download?*

- **The Fix:** It is highly recommended to click the **Cancel** button first to cleanly abort the stream sub-process. Closing the window aggressively mid-download can leave orphan background processing tasks running on your computer's CPU until your next restart.